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Study Courses

- The following types of study or training programs allow a non-EU student to apply for a National Visa (Type D) for study purposes in Greece:
- Undergraduate degree programs (Bachelor's).
- Postgraduate degree programs (Master's).
- Doctoral studies (PhD).
- Vocational training at recognized Institutes of Vocational Training (IEK).
- Participation in exchange programs (such as Erasmus+).
- Language preparation courses, provided they are a prerequisite for entry into a higher education program.
- Research programs at recognized Greek research centers.

Embassy Appointment

- To book an appointment for a study visa, students generally follow these steps:
- Visit the official website of the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the Hellenic Republic to find the competent Greek Embassy or Consulate in their country of residence.
- Check if the Embassy uses an external service provider, such as Global Visa Center World (GVCW).
- Create an account on the relevant online booking portal (either the Embassy's direct system or the service provider's portal).
- Select the "National Visa - Study" category and choose an available date and time.
- Print the appointment confirmation to present at the entrance of the Embassy or Consulate.

Applying for a Study Visa

The process for obtaining a Type D National Visa involves several specific steps:

Application Steps:

- Receive an official Letter of Acceptance from a Greek educational institution.
- Obtain the necessary documentation (criminal record, health certificate, financial proof).
- Book an appointment at the Embassy or Consulate.
- Attend an in-person interview and submit biometric data (fingerprints).
- Pay the visa fee.
- Wait for the processing of the application.

Processing Time:

- The processing time typically ranges from 10 to 30 days.
- *Correction: per the Schengen Visa Code (Regulation (EC) No. 810/2009, Art. 23), which governs Greek national visa decisions, the standard processing time is a*

minimum of 15 calendar days, extendable up to 30 days when further scrutiny is needed.

- In some cases, it may take up to 60 days if additional verification of documents is required.

Documents Needed

Before attending the visa interview, students must prepare the following:

- A valid passport with at least two blank pages, valid for at least three months after the visa's expiration.
- A completed and signed National Visa application form.
- **One recent passport-sized color photograph.**
- *Correction: Greek consulates and the Visa Application Centres acting as the Ministry of Foreign Affairs' external service provider (e.g., GVCW) generally require two recent (within 6 months) passport-sized color photographs meeting ICAO/Schengen specifications, not one.*
- Certificate of Acceptance/Registration from the Greek educational institution.
- Proof of language proficiency required for the course.
- Original Criminal Record Certificate from the home country, legalized (Apostille) and translated.
- Medical Certificate from a recognized state or private doctor, stating the applicant does not suffer from diseases defined by the World Health Organization.
- Travel insurance covering the duration of the visa (minimum coverage €30,000).
- Proof of payment of the visa fee (€90 for most students, though fees can vary by nationality or specific bilateral agreements).

Money Requirements

Students must demonstrate they have sufficient funds to cover their living expenses while in Greece:

- The minimum amount required is €400 per month for the duration of the stay.
- Total annual amount required for a one-year visa is €4,800.
- Acceptable proof of funds includes bank statements from the last 6 months, scholarship certificates, or proof of a blocked account.
- If parents or legal guardians are supporting the student, an affidavit of support along with their financial documents must be provided.

Residence Permit

Upon arrival in Greece, a student must apply for a residence permit before their visa expires:

- The application must be submitted electronically through the "Electronic Services" portal of the Ministry of Migration and Asylum.
- The student must apply for the "Residence Permit for Study Purposes."
- Biometric data must be provided at the competent Decentralized Administration (Aliens and Immigration Department) following the online submission.
- The applicant will receive a "Blue Paper" (Vevaiosi), which serves as a temporary residence permit until the electronic card is issued.

Working While Studying

Non-EU students are permitted to work in Greece under the following conditions:

- Students are allowed to work part-time only.
- The maximum limit is 20 hours per week during the semester.
- Full-time work is allowed only during official academic holidays.
- Students must obtain a Tax Identification Number (AFM) and a Social Security Number (AMKA) to be legally employed.

Renewing the Residence Permit

If the course duration exceeds one year, the residence permit must be renewed:

- The renewal application must be submitted at least two months before the current permit expires.
- Renewal is done through the online portal of the Ministry of Migration and Asylum.
- Required documents include proof of continued enrollment and evidence of successful completion of exams/progress in studies.
- Updated proof of financial means and health insurance must be provided.

Changing to a Work Permit

After completing studies, students may change their status under specific conditions:

- Graduates of Greek Higher Education institutions may apply for a residence permit to seek employment or establish a business for a period of up to one year (Job Seeker Visa).
- If a student finds a job relevant to their studies during this period, they can apply for a residence permit for "Highly Qualified Employment" (EU Blue Card) or a standard "Employment" permit.
- The transition requires a valid employment contract with a salary meeting the legal minimum for the specific permit type.

Official Information

Official information can be found at the following governmental sources:

- Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the Hellenic Republic (mfa.gr).
- Ministry of Migration and Asylum (migration.gov.gr).
- Study in Greece (studyingreece.edu.gr) - The official portal for international students.
- Governmental Portal for Electronic Services (gov.gr).

Application Forms

Official forms can be accessed at:

- The Ministry of Foreign Affairs "Documents" section for the National Visa (Type D) form.
- The Ministry of Migration and Asylum "Electronic Services" portal for residence permit application templates.

- Individual Greek Embassy websites usually provide downloadable PDF versions of the visa application form.

Tips for Students

Common mistakes and how to avoid them:

- Submitting non-legalized documents: Ensure all foreign documents (criminal record, medical certificates) have the Apostille stamp or are legalized by the Greek Consulate.
- Insufficient financial proof: Ensure the bank statements are recent and clearly show the required monthly amount without excluding transaction history.
- Late residence permit application: Always apply for the residence permit immediately after arrival; waiting until the visa is about to expire can lead to legal complications.
- Incomplete translations: All documents must be translated into Greek by the Translation Service of the Ministry of Foreign Affairs or a certified lawyer.
- Ignoring email notifications: The online residence permit system communicates via email; check spam folders regularly for appointment notifications for biometric data collection.

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1. Study Courses That Allow a Non-EU Student to Apply for a Study Visa

To study in Greece, a non-EU student must have been accepted as a student at a higher education institution and attend a specific course of study. The following types of programmes qualify:

- Undergraduate (Bachelor's) degree programmes at public or private universities accredited by the Greek Ministry of Education
- Postgraduate (Master's) degree programmes
- Doctoral (PhD) programmes
- Language learning courses that are a prerequisite set by the higher education institution
- Vocational training programmes at recognised institutions

The institution must be certified by the Greek Ministry of Education.

2. Embassy Appointment: How to Book

Appointments are often booked online through the respective embassy or consulate portals. During peak seasons, such as summer, appointment slots can fill up quickly, so students should book well in advance. Some countries may require booking through a third-party service such as VFS Global.

For certain countries, the Greek Ministry of Foreign Affairs works through its exclusive external service provider, Global Visa Center World (GVCW), which is present in 18 countries and 80 cities around the world and can assist with student visa applications.

Steps to book an appointment:

- Visit the official website of the Greek embassy or consulate in your country of residence: www.mfa.gr/en/contact/greek-missions-abroad/
- Check whether your country uses VFS Global or GVCW for appointment booking
- Select the national (D-type) visa category for studies
- Book your slot as early as possible, ideally several months before your intended start date

3. Applying for a Study Visa: Steps, Documents, and Timeline

Visa Type

Most non-EU/EEA citizens will require a National (D-Type) Visa for long-term stays exceeding 90 days. This visa is specifically for students enrolled in recognised higher education institutions, language schools, or vocational training programmes.

Steps to Apply

- Secure an official acceptance letter from a recognised Greek educational institution
- Gather all required documents (see Section 4)
- Book and attend an appointment at the Greek embassy or consulate in your country of residence
- Submit documents, give biometrics, and pay the visa fee
- Wait for the visa decision
- Upon arrival in Greece, submit a residence permit application to the Aliens and Immigration Department of the Decentralised Administration within 30 days of arrival.
- Correction: According to the official Visa and Residence Permit Guide for Students published by the Greek Ministry of Foreign Affairs and consistent with Law 4251/2014, students must submit their residence permit application within 90 days of entry into Greece, not 30 days. Source: Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Visa and Residence Permit Guide for Students (www.mfa.gr).

Processing Time

Processing time is typically 4 to 8 weeks, but can extend to 12 weeks or more during peak seasons. It is crucial to apply well in advance.

Visa Fee

The national (D) visa fee is around 90 to 180 euros depending on the consulate and the student's nationality.

Correction: The official Visa and Residence Permit Guide for Students published by the Greek Ministry of Foreign Affairs states that the national (D-type) student visa fee is 90 euros. No range of up to 180 euros is established in official governmental sources. Source: Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Visa and Residence Permit Guide for Students, section 2c (www.mfa.gr).

4. Documents Needed for the Study Visa Application

The core set of documents required includes a valid passport, a university acceptance letter, proof of approximately 600 to 700 euros per month (7,000 to 8,000 euros per year), proof of health insurance, a clean criminal record certificate,

evidence of accommodation, and passport-sized photographs. Many documents need an apostille and a certified Greek translation.

Correction: The official Visa and Residence Permit Guide for Students (Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Joint Ministerial Decree No. 41712/2014, Government Gazette No. 2285, Issue B) specifies that proof of adequate income must amount to at least 400 euros per month. The figures of 600 to 700 euros per month or 7,000 to 8,000 euros per year are not established in official governmental sources. Source: Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Visa and Residence Permit Guide for Students, section 2c (www.mfa.gr).

Full standard document list:

- Valid passport (with at least two blank pages and valid for the duration of the stay)
- Completed visa application form (available at www.mfa.gr)
- Official acceptance or enrolment letter from the Greek institution, specifying programme, duration, and tuition fees
- **Proof of sufficient financial means (bank statements, scholarship letter, or sponsor letter) showing approximately 600 to 700 euros per month**
- Correction: As per the Ministry of Foreign Affairs official guide, the required minimum is at least 400 euros per month, not 600 to 700 euros per month. Source: Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Visa and Residence Permit Guide for Students, Joint Ministerial Decree No. 41712/2014 (www.mfa.gr).
- Proof of paid enrolment fees, where applicable
- Comprehensive medical insurance valid in the Schengen area
- Medical certificate confirming freedom from contagious diseases
- Criminal record certificate (police clearance) from your home country and any country of residence in the past 5 years
- Proof of accommodation in Greece (rental agreement, dormitory reservation, or host letter)
- Passport-sized photographs

5. Money Requirements

For a student visa, you must show proof of funds of at least 7,200 euros per year.

Correction: The official Ministry of Foreign Affairs Visa and Residence Permit Guide for Students, referencing Joint Ministerial Decree No. 41712/2014, sets the required amount at a minimum of 400 euros per month. There is no official governmental basis for the figure of 7,200 euros per year. Source: Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Visa and Residence Permit Guide for Students (www.mfa.gr).

Greek authorities require you to show that you can support yourself with roughly 600 to 700 euros per month, approximately 7,000 to 8,000 euros for a full academic year. The funds can be in your own bank account, a parent's account with a notarised

sponsor letter, or a confirmed scholarship. Show the full annual amount, not one month's balance, as this is the most common rejection trigger.

Correction: The official governmental threshold is at least 400 euros per month, not 600 to 700 euros per month. The advice to show full annual funds and the methods of proof (own account, sponsor letter, scholarship) are consistent with official guidance; only the stated amount is incorrect. Source: Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Visa and Residence Permit Guide for Students, Joint Ministerial Decree No. 41712/2014 (www.mfa.gr).

6. Residence Permit: How to Apply After Arriving in Greece

Once accepted at a higher education institution and holding a D-type visa, you must apply for a residence permit after arrival. Residence permits for studies are of one year duration and are renewable for one year each time. If the duration of studies is shorter than one year, the residence permit is issued for that period. Applicants should pay a fee of 150 euros for each year they apply.

Steps after arrival:

- Collect all required documents for the residence permit application and ensure all documents are translated into Greek by a certified translator and apostilled or legalised if required.
- Since 2024, most applications are submitted electronically through the Ministry of Migration and Asylum portal at applications.migration.gov.gr.
- Schedule an appointment with the relevant Aliens and Immigration Department
- Submit the complete application package and pay the fees. You will receive a blue receipt (known in Greek as the "mple veveosi") which serves as temporary proof of legal stay.
- Attend a biometrics appointment (fingerprints and photograph)
- Obtain a Greek Tax Identification Number (AFM) from the local tax office (DOY)
- Obtain your social security number (AMKA) from e-EFKA offices or KEP centres

7. Working While Studying

Students holding a study residence permit can work part-time.

Holders of the student residence permit may work part-time (20 hours per week) during the academic year and full-time during holidays.

Students should obtain their AMKA (social security number) before starting any employment, as this is required by Greek law for formal employment contracts.

8. Renewing the Residence Permit

Residence permits for studies are valid for one year and are renewable. Applicants may apply for a residence permit covering as many years as their course of study. However, a multi-annual permit holder must submit every two years an enrolment certificate, a certificate of participation in examinations, and an updated transcript to the Decentralised Administration. If the permit holder fails to do so, the permit is withdrawn and the student must immediately leave the country.

The duration of the residence permit cannot exceed the duration of the course of study, increased by four terms, or by half in the case of postgraduate or doctoral students. An additional year may be added for the language learning year, provided that this is a prerequisite of the higher education institution.

Practical renewal steps:

- Begin renewal proceedings at least 2 to 3 months before the permit expires
- Submit updated enrolment certificate and exam participation certificate
- Submit updated health insurance for the new period
- Pay the renewal fee of 150 euros per year
- Use the online portal at applications.migration.gov.gr

9. Changing to a Work Permit After Finishing Studies

After completion of studies, the student must return to their home country and submit a fresh application from there. You cannot change status to a residence permit for another purpose from within Greece.

Correction: This statement was accurate under the prior legal framework but is no longer correct. Law 5275/2026 (published 6 February 2026), amending the Immigration Code, explicitly provides that non-EU citizens who entered Greece for studies or research may remain in Greece for one year after completing their studies or research under a Type H.11 residence permit in order to seek employment or establish a business, without the requirement to return to their home country. The change of residence permit category may occur either upon expiry or during the validity period of the current permit. Source: Law 5275/2026, Article 13; EY Greece Tax Alert, Law 5275/2026 (February 2026); Bernitsas Law Briefing, Overview of Greece's New Immigration Legislation (www.bernitsaslaw.com).

This means:

- A student residence permit cannot be converted to a work permit from inside Greece
- Correction: Under Law 5275/2026, graduates may apply for a Type H.11 residence permit to seek employment or establish a business from within Greece, without returning to their home country. Source: Law 5275/2026, Article 13.

- After graduating, the student must return home and apply for a national (D-type) work visa at the Greek embassy or consulate in their country of residence
- Correction: Under Law 5275/2026, graduates may remain in Greece for up to one year under a Type H.11 permit for job-seeking or business establishment purposes, without returning to their home country first. Source: Law 5275/2026, Article 13.
- The employer in Greece must sponsor and support this application
- The new work visa leads to a separate employment residence permit upon arrival in Greece
- The governing legislation is Law 4251/2014 (Immigration and Social Integration Code), as amended by Law 5275/2026

10. Official Government Websites

- Ministry of Migration and Asylum (residence permits, legislation): <https://migration.gov.gr/en/>
- Ministry of Foreign Affairs (visas, embassies, application forms): <https://www.mfa.gr/en/visas/>
- Online Residence Permit Application Portal: <https://applications.migration.gov.gr/en/metanasteusi/>
- European Commission – Student in Greece (EU-level overview): https://home-affairs.ec.europa.eu/policies/migration-and-asylum/eu-immigration-portal/student-greece_en
- Study in Greece (official national information portal): <https://studyinggreece.edu.gr/before-arrival/>
- Ministry of Education, Religious Affairs and Sport: <https://www.minedu.gov.gr/>
- Greek Diplomatic Missions Abroad (embassy locator): <https://www.mfa.gr/en/contact/greek-missions-abroad/>

11. Application Forms

- National (D-Type) Long-Stay Visa Application Form: Available directly at www.mfa.gr/en/visas/ and at the Greek embassy or consulate in your country
- Medical Certificate required for the visa: Available at <https://studyinggreece.edu.gr/before-arrival/>
- Residence Permit Application (online submission): <https://applications.migration.gov.gr/en/metanasteusi/>

The application form for a visa can be found on the Ministry of Foreign Affairs website.

12. Common Mistakes and How to Avoid Them

- **Insufficient proof of funds.** Showing only a few weeks' balance gets applications rejected. You must show the full annual sum of approximately 7,000 to 8,000 euros, not just one month's balance.
- **Correction:** The official minimum financial requirement is 400 euros per month (not 7,000 to 8,000 euros per year) per the Ministry of Foreign Affairs Visa and Residence Permit Guide and Joint Ministerial Decree No. 41712/2014. The advice to show sufficient funds over the full intended period remains sound; only the cited amounts are incorrect. Source: Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Visa and Residence Permit Guide for Students (www.mfa.gr).
- **Missing apostilles and certified translations.** Many documents must be apostilled and officially translated into Greek. Starting this process late causes delays.
- **Applying too late.** The July to September peak period before the autumn intake is significantly slower for processing. Students should submit applications by early summer for an October start.
- **Not applying for the residence permit promptly after arrival.** Upon arrival, students must apply for their residence permit within the required timeframe. Failure to do so will result in an illegal stay status.
- **Inadequate health insurance.** Submitting a policy that does not explicitly cover Greece or does not meet consulate requirements is a common cause of rejection.
- **Not keeping health insurance certificates each year.** In accordance with regulations issued by the Ministry of Migration and Asylum in 2024, it is mandatory to retain a copy of your health insurance certificate for each year you hold a residence permit. Upon renewal, you must submit all previous health insurance certificates for the duration of your current permit.
- **Missing renewal deadlines.** Begin the renewal process at least 2 to 3 months before the permit expires, and never later than one month after expiry, to avoid fines and potential loss of legal status.
- **Correction:** Under Law 5275/2026 (Article 12), the deadline for submitting a late renewal application has been extended from one month to three months following the expiry of the residence permit, subject to an administrative fine of 100 euros per month of delay. Applications cannot be submitted after three months from expiry, except in cases of force majeure. Source: Law 5275/2026, Article 12; EY Greece Tax Alert, Law 5275/2026 (www.ey.com/en_gr).
- **Expecting to change status inside Greece.** Students who wish to work after graduation must apply from their home country, not from within Greece.
- **Correction:** Under Law 5275/2026, graduates may remain in Greece and apply for a Type H.11 residence permit for job-seeking or business

establishment purposes from within Greece, without returning to their home country. Source: Law 5275/2026, Article 13.